

11. TALKING DEAD

Niches near the floor are filled with stacked bones, and skulls are neatly arranged about six inches apart along a ledge. The wall above the skulls bears an inscription, partially obscured by centuries of accumulated dust and cobwebs.

The inscription can be read if the debris is cleared away. It states, in archaic Common, "A question speak you, and answer will these departed."

The dead in this section of the catacombs were interred at a time when people considered it desirable to be able to speak at will with their deceased ancestors per an enchantment resembling *speak with dead*.

- As with that spell, they know nothing about events that transpired after their deaths, so the skulls can't answer questions about what's been happening in the catacombs recently.
- They may recall lore about the catacombs that they knew in life, however, and some of that could include things even the faithful of Kelemvor don't know.
- More than one skull responds to most questions, and sometimes their answers are contradictory, just as any group of people's would be.

The spell that compels these spirits to talk is ancient and fading, and the spirits themselves are only weakly held to this place. They cease responding to the characters' inquiries after they've answered five questions.

12. CRIME SCENES

Just as important political, social, and religious figures from Phlan's history are immortalized in areas 3 and 4, some of its worst criminals are immortalized here. In this case, however, the roles of murderer and victim have been reversed.

This area has displays similar to those previously in the catacombs, but with one major difference. Where the previous displays were pleasant depictions of daily life, these are nightmares come to life. In one crypt, the skeletons of three, very young children are posed as if they are strangling a grown man, while another portrays five people holding a skeletal man in a chair and "pouring" something from a greasy, brown vial down his throat.

Piles of dirt and rubble have been deposited around the room.

The "victims" in these vignettes committed mass murder or other atrocious crimes, and their "killers" were their victims in life. Here, the victims were allowed their eternal revenge. This practice fell out of fashion long ago in Phlan, so no new burials have been added here in over a century.

13. THE NECROPOLIS AND BEYOND

This section of the catacombs is where most new interments take place. As such, Cassyt and other faithful of Kelemvor are more familiar with it than with other areas.

A thousand untold secrets exist in this place. It stretches for hundreds of feet beneath the surface; a person could explore its depths for days and not see all that it contains.

Rumor has it that the hidden tomb of Miltiades, a legendary undead paladin is within this section of the catacombs, though no one has claimed to have found it.

It's as if you've entered a subterranean city. The crypts here are modeled after surface homes and other buildings, although they're only about two-thirds the size of their real counterparts.

Coming from somewhere to your left, you hear sounds of scratching and scraping. How far off it's coming from is very difficult to judge in these tunnels.

As it is now, however, the Necropolis is infested with undead. For each hour that the adventurers spend wandering the area, roll 1d4 and consult the Wandering Monsters table to determine what the party meets.

If the adventurers spend enough time down here to come across all three encounters, they do not encounter any others. Additionally, Doomguide Yovir does not ask for their assistance in clearing the rest of the catacombs.

WANDERING MONSTERS

D4 Roll	Result
1	Ghouls (1d4)
2	Zombies (1d6)
3	Skeletons (1d6)
4	Nothing

14A. THE SENTRY

The Red Wizard Rorreth Monforoth and his Cult of the Dragon accomplices have taken this portion of the catacombs as their temporary base of operations. He has a modest contingent of undead gathered here.

A group of four **zombies** stand guard just inside of the

portion of this area labeled “b”. In addition, a **kobold** sentinel is here, sitting in a chair, sound asleep. If the adventurers sprung any of the traps in Area 12, the zombies will not be here; having previously investigated the noise and encountered the party. The kobold, however, was sleeping too soundly to have been awoken by the racket and is still here napping.

This room is littered with rubble and freshly turned earth. Sitting next to a barrel next to an opening on the far side of the wall, is a kobold dozing quietly in a small wooden chair.

A sneaky adventurer can attack him while he is still asleep, provided that they are not seen by the zombies. Because he is unconscious, he loses his Dexterity modifier to AC and attacks are made against him with advantage, but the barrels grants him three-quarters cover, which raises his AC to 15. The first missed attack wakes the kobold who immediately starts shouting, initiating combat.

Upon seeing the adventurers, the kobold wants nothing more than to run into area 14b to warn the cultist fanatic and Rorreth. If the kobold is alive when his turn arrives, read:

The kobold grabs his sword and runs through the opening yipping excitedly.
Beyond the opening, you can hear raised voices and the tell-tale sound of swords being drawn from scabbards.

If the kobold is slain without having the chance to raise the alarm, the zombies attack as normal. If the kobold raises the alarm, the Thayans and cultists in area 14b begin preparing immediately. Otherwise, they are alarmed by the sounds of the adventurers combating the zombies and begin their preparation on the following round.

TACTICS

The kobold's only job is to make as much noise as possible when it sees someone that shouldn't be there.

As usual, the zombies simply mob the adventurers.

ADJUSTING THE ENCOUNTER

Here are recommendations for adjusting this combat encounter. These are not cumulative.

- **Very weak or weak party:** remove two zombies
- **Strong party:** add two zombies
- **Very strong party:** add a ghoul

14B. THE RED WIZARD

Even at first glance, it is obvious that people have been living in this room for a long while. There are a number of straw pallets and even a pair of beds.

Across the room, a man in embroidered red robes with a shaved and tattooed head is hurriedly stuffing items into a haversack. As he sees you, he spits out a curse and shouts for his minions to attack.

The fight with the zombies in area 14a has given **Rorreth** the time to prepare his escape via a teleportation circle. Rorreth is accompanied by a Thayan **knight (T)** and a **cultist (C)**, along with a **zombie (Z)**, and two **kobolds (K)** (including the kobold from area 14a that ran here to warn them). If the adventurers spend 4 rounds or more fighting the zombies in area 14a, the Thayan knight or the cultist is invisible when the adventurers arrive (see Rorreth's Flight, below).

RORRETH'S FLIGHT

Each round that the adventurers spend fighting the zombies in area 14a, is a round that Rorreth has to pack away incriminating documents and maps. The results of his efforts are based primarily on the amount of warning he has to prepare. Beginning with the round that the kobold shouts his alarm or combat with the zombies begins (whichever occurs first), Rorreth's performs specific actions each round until they arrive and enter initiative with the inhabitants of Area 14b:

- **Round 1.** Rorreth issues brief instructions to his guard, moves to his desk, grabs his haversack, and casts *mage armor* on himself.
- **Round 2.** Rorreth packs his personal journal in his haversack and begins to sort through the remaining documents on the desk.
- **Round 3.** He retrieves his orders from Rath Modar and secures them in his haversack.
- **Round 4.** He casts *invisibility* on the Thayan knight or the cultist.
- **Round 5+.** Rorreth continues to rummage through the desk to ensure that no incriminating evidence remains.

FOES & TACTICS

At the beginning of combat, Rorreth is 20 feet away from teleportation circle set into the floor. On his turn, he moves to the circle and teleports away as a bonus action. He has no interest in fighting the adventurers—he has

important work to do.

Rorreth is an accomplished mage and unless the adventurers are able to kill or incapacitate him or prevent him from speaking, he escapes. Even if physically restrained, he uses *misty step* to reach to the circle and teleport away. On his turn after the adventurers arrive in Area 14b, read:

The wizard steps into a circle of silver runes on the floor and after muttering a single word, is enveloped in a blinding flash of green light. When your eyes clear, the man is nowhere to be seen.

The zombie and the Thayan knight engage the adventurers in melee while the kobolds use ranged attacks. The cultist engages the characters in melee.

The Thayan knight carries a vial of poison. If she begins a turn at 5 hit points or less, consumes it; killing her instantly.

The kobolds each have a **stinkpot** available to use with their sling. These deal no damage, but any creature struck by one must succeed on a DC 10 Constitution saving throw or be poisoned for 1 minute. The creature can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect early on a success.

CASSYT

Until this point, she has mostly been assisting the party as a guide and casting an occasional cantrip. However, upon seeing the wizard who is responsible for creating the undead, she becomes furious.

In the first round of combat, she casts *bless* on the three characters that she feels have performed the best in the adventure so far. If there are any undead present in the encounter, Cassyt has a single use of Turn Undead in addition to her spells. She uses it in the second round of combat. In subsequent rounds, she casts *sacred flame*, saving her two remaining 1st-level spell slots to cast *sanctuary* as needed. She prefers to attack the wizard if he is present, and the undead if he is not.

"No longer will you profane this place with your presence!"

--Cassyt

TURN UNDEAD

As an action, Cassyt presents her holy symbol and speaks a prayer censuring the undead. Each undead that can see or hear her within 30 feet of her must make a Wisdom saving throw. If the creature fails its saving throw, it is turned for 1 minute or until it takes any damage.

A turned creature must spend its turns trying to move as far away from her as it can, and it can't willingly move to a space within 30 feet of her. It also can't take reactions. For its action, it can use only the Dash action or try to escape from an effect that prevents it from moving. If there's nowhere to move, the creature can use the Dodge action.

DEVELOPMENTS

If characters are triumphant and explore the inner chambers of area 14a, they find a modest-sized room, appointed in the furnishings of living quarters—a few straw pallets, a couple chests (full of mundane personal belongings), and a table with a few chairs—all in complete disarray. Furniture has been turned over and upset, papers are strewn all about the room. Among them, only a set of maps of the catacombs are of any interest. The maps are labeled in Draconic. If the adventurers are unable to translate them, Doomguide Glandon offers to do so, even going so far as to say that they are the most accurate set of maps of the catacombs that he has ever seen and asks to keep them.

Area 14a also has a narrow tunnel that exits this area toward the southeast. It proceeds for about 60 feet before it appears ends in a wall of stone and rubble. This tunnel appears on the maps found by the adventurers, labeled (in Draconic) with an arrow pointing further east and a single word—"Pool."

If the cultist is captured alive, he does not willingly divulge any of their secrets. Any punishment that the Cult might mete out for his betrayal would be far worse than anything the adventurers are likely willing to do. Any question to that effect is met with an insult, a mouthful of spittle, or—more likely—both. If compelled to speak, by use of *charm person* or similar ability, he knows only that he was sent to Valhingen to assist Rorreth in creating an army of undead. Once done, they were to use the undead to dig towards Phlan and begin the search for the Pool of Radiance.

While the adventurers were occupied in Area 14b, Monforoth was busy packing his haversack with any items that he felt might implicate the Red Wizards of Thay. If he escapes, he takes his haversack with him. In the unlikely event that he is killed or captured before teleporting away, however, his pack contains a journal containing rather shocking information about the Thayan wizards's plans to assist the Cult of the Dragon

in freeing Tiamat from her imprisonment and his reluctance in joining the cause of the exile Rath Modar.

Additionally, there are a set of documents from Rath Modar that charge Rorreth with creating a host of undead in the catacombs beneath Valhingen Cemetery and to use them to dig their way south and east beneath Phlan in an attempt to locate the Pool of Radiance. There are extensive maps and calculations done that estimate the general direction, depth and distance that he must dig to end up beneath Valjevo Keep (where the Pool is last believed to be).

At this point, however, the adventurers have identified the source of the undead. With a little more work, and some assistance from the adventurers, the Kelemvorites are able to destroy the undead that remain.

ADJUSTING THE ENCOUNTER

Here are recommendations for adjusting this combat encounter. These are not cumulative.

- **Very weak party:** remove the Thayan knight and the zombie
- **Weak party:** remove the Thayan knight and add two zombies
- **Strong party:** add three kobolds in the back room
- **Very strong party:** add three zombies, add three kobolds in the back room

TREASURE

In the back room, Rorreth kept a lockbox containing 100 gp in various types of coins. Additionally, he left behind a fine writing set in the desk worth 75 gp. The Thayan knight has a pouch with 45 gp in it and the cult fanatic has a pouch containing 25 gp. The kobolds between them have 5 gp in coins along with a few worthless pieces of junk and a dead mouse.

CONCLUSION

With the adventurers successful in discovering the source of the undead within the catacombs, their work is done. While Doomguide Glandon insinuates that their assistance would be helpful in clearing out the Necropolis of undead.

He is dismayed at the mention of a wizard in the catacombs, and even more so at the map's mention of a "pool". He goes so far to reveal that the arrow likely points in the direction of Valjevo Keep, but stops before guessing as to what the caption actually refers to.

Their task done, he thanks the adventurers for their work and begs the character's leave—saying he has much to discuss with his fellow clergy, the Lord Regent, and the Lord Sage.

Cassyt is Still Alive. Doomguide Glandon is also

especially pleased with Cassyt's recounting of the events that transpired. As recognition of her efforts in the defeat of the Red Wizard, Doomguide Glandon inducts Cassyt into the Most Solemn Order of the Silent Shroud; the formal clergy of Kelemvor.

REWARDS

Make sure note their rewards on their adventure logsheets. Give your name and DCI number (if applicable) so players can record who ran the session.

EXPERIENCE

Total up all **combat experience** earned for defeated foes, and divide by the number of characters present in the combat. For **non-combat experience**, the rewards are listed per character. Give all characters in the party non-combat experience awards unless otherwise noted.

COMBAT AWARDS

Name of Foe	XP per Foe
Knight	700
Rorreth (Red Wizard)	450
Ghoul	200
Spy	200
Thug	100
Skeleton	50
Zombie	50
Bandit	25
Cultist	25
Kobold	25

NON-COMBAT AWARDS

Task or Accomplishment	XP per Character
Successfully disable the throne trap	75
Convinced Cassyt not to tell	50
Helped the Welcomers escape	50
Welcomers left their loot behind	50
Avoiding the Bone Pit	25
Safely navigated stairs	25

The **minimum** total award for each character participating in this adventure is **450 experience points**.

The **maximum** total award for each character participating in this adventure is **600 experience points**.

TREASURE

The characters receive the following treasure, divided up amongst the party. Characters should attempt to divide treasure evenly whenever possible. Gold piece

values listed for sellable gear are calculated at their selling price, not their purchase price.

Consumable magic items should be divided up however the group sees fit. If more than one character is interested in a specific consumable magic item, the DM can determine who gets it randomly should the group be unable to decide.

Permanent magic items are divided according to a system. See the sidebar if the adventure awards permanent magic items.

TREASURE AWARDS

Item Name	GP Value
Payment from Doomguide Glandon	100
Jewelry from area 3	40
Clothing from area 3	60
Trinkets from crematoria	130
Welcomer pouches	20
Sedrair's crown	250
Sedrair's crown (ruined)	50
Sedrair's weights and balance	80
Sedrair's gold dagger	12
Stones from Sedrair's throne	8
Rorreth's lockbox	100
Writing set	75
Thayan's pouch	45
Cultist's pouch	25
Kobolds' pouches	5

GOGGLES OF NIGHT

Wondrous item, uncommon

These brass-framed goggles feel cool to the touch when worn. While wearing them, you have darkvision out to a range of 60 feet. If you already have darkvision, these goggles extend that range by 60 feet. A full description of this item can be found in the basic rules or the *Dungeon Master's Guide*.

PERMANENT MAGIC ITEM DISTRIBUTION

D&D Adventurers League has a system in place to determine who is awarded permanent magic items at the end of a session. Each character's logsheet contains a column to record permanent magic items for ease of reference.

- If all the players at the table agree on one character taking possession of a permanent magic item, that character gets the item.
- In the event that one or more characters indicate an interest in possessing a permanent magic item, the character that possesses the fewest permanent magic items gets the item. If there is a tie in the total number of permanent magic items owned by contesting characters, the item's owner is determined randomly by the DM.

RENOWN

All faction members earn **one renown point** for participating in this adventure.

DOWNTIME

Each character receives **ten downtime days** at the conclusion of this adventure.

FAVORS AND ENMITY

The characters have the opportunity to earn the following enmity during the course of play.

Enmity of Doomguide Yovir Glandon. Despite his requests, you were caught stealing from the resting dead or allowed others to do so. Because of this, all members of Kelemvor's clergy in Phlan are highly distrustful of you. So long as you have this enmity, all future Charisma (Deception, Intimidation, or Persuasion) checks made against members of Kelemvor's faithful in Phlan are made with disadvantage. Additionally, the cost for any spellcasting services provided by the clergy is increased by 10%.

Enmity of the Welcomers. You slew one or more members of the Welcomers for little more than petty theft. So long as you have this enmity, all future Charisma (Deception, Intimidation, or Persuasion) checks made against members of the Welcomers faithful are made with disadvantage.

Favor of the Welcomers. You helped a small group of Welcomers escape from the Catacombs without informing Doomguide Glandon. So long as you have this favor, all future Charisma (Deception, Intimidation, or Persuasion) checks made against members of the Welcomers faithful are made with advantage.

DM REWARDS

You receive **200 XP** and **ten downtime days** for running this session.